



CATHOLIC MEN ORGANIZATION

(C.M.O.)

HOLY CROSS CATHOLIC CHURCH

Badawa – Kano Diocese

Bye-Laws and Guidelines as Amended

2023

“That all may be one”

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A. PREAMBLE

The Catholic Men Organization, hereinafter called “CMO”, of Holy Cross Church Badawa, hereinafter called “the Parish”, is a body of Catholic faithful established in 2002. The aim of CMO includes, among other things:

- Uniting all men in the Parish.
- Initiating as well as promoting pastoral and developmental activities in upholding the teaching / doctrines of the Catholic Church.
- Speaking in one voice with the Diocesan body of Catholic Men Organization.
- Assisting members who may be in particular needs as spelt out in this document.
- Cooperating with the Parish administration in all evangelization programmes.

We, the members of CMO, hereby give ourselves the following guidelines / bye-laws to govern the activities of CMO in Holy Cross Catholic Church, Badawa.

B. MEMBERSHIP

Membership is open to all men in the parish upon payment of a registration fee of ₦1,000.00 (One Thousand Naira) only and another Eight Hundred and Fifty Naira (₦850.00) as registration fee to the Laity Council, and an annual Membership Card, hereafter referred to as (AMC), of the parish.

C. MEETINGS

CMO shall hold the following meetings:

1. General meeting once a month, on the second Sunday of every month.
2. Executive meeting as frequently as the executive deems fit, but at least once a month before the general meeting.
3. Emergency meeting, which can be called at any time to discuss urgent matters that may be too late if kept for the general meeting.

D. EXECUTIVE COUNCIL AND THEIR DUTIES

The following officers shall constitute the executive council of CMO in the parish:

1. Chairman - Whose duty shall be to preside over the meetings of CMO and be a signatory to the CMO account.
2. Vice Chairman - Whose duty shall be to assist the chairman and act as chairman when the chairman is absent, except as a signatory to the account. He shall also perform any other duty the CMO may assign to him.
3. General Secretary - Whose duty shall be to take accurate record of all proceedings of CMO meetings in consultation with the chairman.
4. Assistant General Secretary - Whose duty shall be to assist the General Secretary and act in the place of same when the General Secretary is absent. He shall also perform any other duty the CMO may assign to him.

5. Financial Secretary – Whose duty shall be to receive and keep accurate record of all CMO finances. He is to be in custody of CMO bank documents and all other valuables except the minute book and correspondences. He is to hand over all cash collected at any point to the Treasurer. He has a duty to present to the general meeting, twice a year, a report showing the indebtedness or otherwise of each member.

6. Treasurer – Whose duty shall be to ensure that all cash collected at any point is lodged into the CMO bank account not later than the NEXT working day following the collection. The evidence of such lodgments (bank teller) must be tendered at the next meeting. He shall also ensure that all expenditure approved by CMO is duly paid. He shall be a signatory to the bank account.

7. Provost – Whose duty shall be to ensure ORDERLINESS at all proceedings.

8. Public Relation Officer (P.R.O.) – Whose duty shall be to disseminate CMO circulars and news to the appropriate places.

9. Welfare Officer – Whose duty shall be to give report on members' welfare, as well as ensure that in all gatherings of CMO there is equity, fairness and justice in all activities, especially in entertainment matters.

10. Auditors (non-elective) – Whose duty shall be to investigate CMO books and ensure that they are in order. He is to report to the general meeting his findings and advice. He shall be appointed when the need arises, but this must be done before any election for new officers takes place.

11. Patron (non-elective) – Whose duty shall be advisory on all matters. His opinion on controversial matters must be respected. He shall be appointed at a general meeting.

12. Grand Pillars – Whose role is to advise the body on prominent issues and give support voluntarily when the need arises.

E. ELECTION AND TENURE OF OFFICERS

A simple majority in a general meeting is required in all elections for a member to stand elected into an office. Each member has one, and only one, vote, with the running officer having a CASTING VOTE in case of a tie. The tenure of the EXECUTIVE is four (4) years from the date of taking over. A bye-election can be conducted to fill any vacant office in the course of the life of an executive council; however, the tenure of such new officer ends with the executive council he joins. An officer cannot be re-elected into the same office for another tenure. An officer can, however, be elected into another office after the expiration of the tenure of the former office.

F. DISSOLUTION OF EXECUTIVE COUNCIL AND HANDING / TAKING OVER

At the end of every executive council's tenure, the council stands dissolved by a motion moved at a general meeting and supported by three members. The Chairman has a duty to announce to members in advance, and at a general meeting, the up-coming tenure expiration, in order to prepare the minds of

members for the subsequent election. Before the dissolution, the house must appoint two members as returning officers for the election. The dissolution of the executive council must necessarily be followed at the same meeting with the election. The handing and taking over of offices should be conducted at the same time. Where this is not possible for any acceptable reason, it must be done at the next general meeting.

NB: There must be a handing-over note from the outgoing Chairman to the incoming Chairman, which must be attached to the current bank statement.

G. ADHOC COMMITTEES

Whenever the need arises, CMO may set up an adhoc committee during a general meeting with clear terms of reference to carry out specific tasks. The life of such committee ends when their task is accomplished and a report submitted to the general meeting.

H. FINANCE

CMO shall derive its funds from the following sources:

1. Registration fee of new members.
2. Monthly dues from members.
3. Levies on members as the need arises.
4. Voluntary donations.
5. Organizing fund-raising activities to support particular projects, apart from regular expenditures which are spelt out in this document.

I. BANK ACCOUNT

CMO shall maintain a single account with a bank that is agreed on at a general meeting. The signatories to the bank account shall be:

- (a) The Chairman
- (b) The Treasurer
- (c) The Parish Priest

At least any two of the signatories must sign for any withdrawal from the bank.

J. FINANCIAL REPORT

The executive council shall present a detailed financial report at the general meeting. The current bank statement must be attached to such report.

K. MEMBERS' BENEFITS

The benefits listed hereunder apply to financially up-to-date members who must have a record of regular attendance to all CMO proceedings. By financially up-to-date is meant he who is not indebted to CMO of any levy, due, or any financial due from such a member — including pledges — for more than one month, and whose membership from the date of registration is at least one year.

i. Sickness

If a member becomes critically sick (like hospitalization or admission), the family he belongs to will be sent to him with the sum of ₦10,000.00 (Ten Thousand). For major surgery, a purse of ₦20,000.00 will be sent to him through the family.

ii. Transfer / Relocation

If a member relocates out of Kano Diocese, a parting gift worth not more than ₦10,000.00 (Ten Thousand Naira) only shall be presented to such member, provided he notifies CMO in writing before a general meeting, and a group photograph shall be taken with such member.

iii. Invitations

(a) Naming ceremony: A member inviting CMO to the naming ceremony of their children shall be given a support of ₦10,000.00 (Ten Thousand Naira). Various families shall contribute ₦2,500 each to raise this amount.

(b) Wedding: A member inviting CMO to his wedding shall receive ₦20,000.00 (Twenty Thousand Naira). Families shall contribute ₦500.00 each. For a wedding outside Kano, he shall receive his full benefit provided CMO is given their rite when he comes back.

(c) Invitation outside CMO: Any member whose child is wedding shall have a sum of ₦5,000 presented as a gift.

(d) Invitation from a youth member shall be honoured as long as the said youth member drops ₦1,000 with an invitation card, and equally the sum of ₦5,000 shall be presented as a gift.

NOTE: For all these invitations, at least a two-month notice must be extended to CMO. Also, CMO members must be recognized at such events, i.e. a table must be set for CMO members and they must be respectfully served.

iv. Death

The death of a member shall invoke the following:

(a) Requiem mass shall be arranged with the Parish Priest.

(b) All members shall attend any wake-keep as may be organized by the deceased member's relatives.

(c) If the remains are to be buried in Kano city, all members must attend the burial.

(d) If the remains are to be buried outside Kano city, CMO will send at least one or two delegates to witness the burial.

(e) The sum of Fifty Thousand Naira (₦50,000.00) only shall be given to the next of kin of the deceased. Members shall pay a levy of ₦1,000 each to raise the amount.

The death of a member's family shall invoke the following:

I. Death of a member's wife: CMO shall mandate the family he belongs to, to condole the bereaved with the purse of Twenty Thousand Naira (₦20,000.00)

only. Members shall pay the sum of ₦500 each for the deceased wife.

II. Death of a member's child: CMO shall mandate the family he belongs to, to condole the bereaved with a purse of Five Thousand Naira (₦5,000.00) only. Members shall pay the sum of ₦200 each for the deceased child.

III. Death of a member's father / mother: CMO shall mandate the family he belongs to, to condole the bereaved with the sum of Ten Thousand Naira (₦10,000.00) only.

L. OTHER OFFENCES AND PENALTIES

1. Lateness to meeting attracts a fine of ₦50.00 (Fifty Naira) only. Lateness shall start immediately after the opening prayer.

2. Absence of an executive member at a meeting has a fine of ₦300.00 (Three Hundred Naira), while a non-executive member has a fine of ₦200.00 (Two Hundred Naira).

3. Betrayal of trust is a serious offence that will attract suspension for a period to be determined by the executive council. If the betrayal is of embezzlement of CMO funds, the culprit must refund the sum involved in addition to being suspended for a period to be determined by the executive council. If the culprit is an executive member, he stands relieved of his post in addition to the suspension.

4. No member shall take another member to police or court without first reporting to CMO for possible settlement. Violation of this shall be viewed as a serious disregard for CMO and the executive council.

5. Any other act of indiscipline capable of ridiculing the integrity of CMO, like falsehood, direct abuse of one another, immorality, fighting, unruly behaviour within or outside the meeting, etc., shall be dealt with on their merits.

M. REGULAR ACTIVITIES

CMO shall organize the following activities:

1. Fathers' Day in conjunction with and / or as directed by the Diocesan Council of CMO.

2. Seminars, Retreats, workshops as the need arises, but at least one of such social enlightenment activities in a year.

3. Observe the first of May as the feast of their Patron Saint (St. Joseph, Patron of Workers) with Holy Mass and charity visits.

4. Carry out other activities that the parish may assign to CMO, as well as participate in all parish functions.

5. Organize award ceremonies as may be needed, especially during the end-of-year party, which shall be agreed upon at a general meeting but must necessarily be preceded by a Thanksgiving Mass.

6. Join in the diocesan functions as may be directed.

N. AMENDMENT

Amendment to any part of this constitution shall be by a motion in a general meeting for such that enjoys a simple majority, provided that the members present at such meeting are not less than half of the registered members of CMO.

CERTIFIED AND ADOPTED

Chairman

Date: 7 / 4 / 2023

Secretary

Date: 6 / 10 / 2023

Parish Priest

Date: 7 / 4 / 2023